

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Project Management English

Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Find the right language. Speak, write, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For project managers, program managers, PMO staff, scrum masters, delivery leads, operations managers, and cross-functional coordinators.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Project Charter and Scope Definition

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

03 Risk Register and Issue Escalation

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

04 Stakeholder Alignment and Governance

Include relevant voices and clarify the decision process.

05 Change Requests and Scope Creep

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

06 Status Reporting and Executive Updates

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

07 Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

08 Post-Implementation Review

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one case and saying a response. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, conversation, writing, and revision.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Project Charter and Scope Definition

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A sponsor requests a dashboard but the brief does not define users, decisions, or excluded features.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

charter - A document establishing a project's purpose, objectives, scope, and authority.

scope - Defined boundary of work, responsibility, deliverables, assumptions, and exclusions.

assumption - Something treated as true for planning or reasoning, though it may need verification.

exclusion - Something outside an agreed scope or expressly not covered by a policy or agreement.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Improve this sentence: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - B. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - C. Could you confirm when does the review start?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - B. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - C. Who will present the report at the meeting?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A testing task is three days late and blocks the release rehearsal. Other work is on schedule.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

critical path - Sequence of dependent work that determines the shortest feasible timeline.

dependency - Work, approval, input, vendor, system, or decision that another activity relies on.

milestone - A significant planned point or achievement used to track progress.

buffer - Extra time, stock, or capacity reserved to absorb variation or delay.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Improve this sentence: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team has completed the review.
 - B. The team is completing the review.
 - C. The team plans to complete the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.
 - B. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - C. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Risk Register and Issue Escalation

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A risk register still lists a supplier delay as a possibility, although the supplier has confirmed it will miss the delivery date.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

risk register - A record of identified risks, their assessments, owners, and planned responses.

issue log - A record of current problems, their impacts, owners, and resolution status.

mitigation - Action taken to reduce likelihood, impact, or exposure of a risk.

owner - Named person or role accountable for a decision, action, deliverable, or risk.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Improve this sentence: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change must have caused the delay.
 - B. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - C. The change may have contributed to the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. Without any uncertainty, the result is ...
 - B. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - C. In every location, the result will be ...

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Stakeholder Alignment and Governance

Include relevant voices and clarify the decision process.

SITUATION

A project meeting ends with several recommendations but no indication of who approves the change.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

governance - Decision structure defining roles, rights, approvals, controls, and accountability.

RACI - A responsibility framework identifying who is responsible, accountable, consulted, and informed.

decision rights - The allocation of authority to recommend, approve, or make particular decisions.

steering committee - A group that oversees an initiative and resolves major direction or governance questions.

3. Notice the language

Summarize the issue neutrally, invite missing perspectives, and distinguish discussion from decision. State who can decide and record any unresolved question. Do not assume silence means agreement.

Let's hear ... before we decide.

The point we still need to resolve is

Who will make this decision, and what do they need?

Improve this sentence: Nobody objected, so everyone agrees.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Help a group reach a clear next step

4. Check the language

1. Which phrase invites a missing perspective?
 - A. We can record their agreement without asking them.
 - B. We haven't heard from the remote team yet; what is your view?
 - C. The remote team has been quiet, so they must agree.
2. Which closing statement records an unresolved decision accurately?
 - A. Approval is pending; the sponsor will review the two options.
 - B. We discussed the options, so approval is complete.
 - C. Everyone spoke, so the decision must be final.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You hold a relevant concern that has not been discussed. Raise it when invited and ask who will decide. Help the facilitator state one unresolved question accurately.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Change Requests and Scope Creep

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

SITUATION

A sponsor asks for a new report two weeks before launch. The team can add it only by moving another feature or extending the schedule.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

change request - A proposal to alter an agreed product, scope, schedule, or process.

scope creep - Expansion of work beyond the agreed scope without corresponding agreement on its effects.

impact analysis - An examination of the effects a proposed change may have.

baseline - A defined starting value or agreed reference used to measure change.

3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Improve this sentence: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Offer a workable tradeoff

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
 - A. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
 - B. If the scope will change, we review yesterday's schedule.
 - C. If the scope changed tomorrow, we reviewed the schedule yesterday.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
 - A. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.
 - B. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.
 - C. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Status Reporting and Executive Updates

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A project is labeled green despite an unresolved dependency that threatens its planned date. The reporting criteria require material threats to be visible.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

status report - A summary of progress, open issues, and relevant next decisions at a stated time.

RAG status - Red, amber, or green status assigned using stated reporting criteria.

trend - A direction or pattern observed across multiple points in time.

decision ask - A clear statement of the decision requested from an audience.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Improve this sentence: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team is completing the review.
 - B. The team plans to complete the review.
 - C. The team has completed the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - B. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - C. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A vendor says a deliverable is complete, but the team cannot find evidence for two acceptance criteria.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

deliverable - A specified item of work to be provided to a customer or project recipient.

acceptance criteria - Specific conditions a deliverable must meet to be accepted.

SLA - Service-level agreement defining expected service performance or response commitments.

escalation - Raising an issue to a higher authority or different function because risk, urgency, or decision rights require it.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Improve this sentence: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Send it on a date later than Thursday.
 - B. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - C. Send it only after Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - B. Could you deal with the relevant matters soon?
 - C. Could you do the needful for the situation?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Post-Implementation Review

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

SITUATION

A project review repeatedly says "communication was poor." The team has no concrete improvement action.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

postmortem - Structured review after an incident or project to identify causes, impacts, lessons, and actions.

lesson learned - A specific insight from experience that can guide future practice.

root cause - Underlying reason a problem occurred, not merely the visible symptom.

action item - A specific task agreed during a discussion, usually assigned to a person.

3. Notice the language

Use a specific example instead of a personality label. Explain its effect, invite the person's perspective, and agree on a practical improvement. Focus on communication that can be changed, not accent or national identity.

In [specific situation], I noticed ...

The effect was ... What was happening from your perspective?

Could we agree to ... and review it ...?

Improve this sentence: You are always careless.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give feedback people can use

4. Check the language

1. Which feedback begins with observable behavior?
 - A. The last two updates omitted the agreed completion date.
 - B. You obviously do not care about our work.
 - C. You are the kind of person who ignores details.
2. Which follow-up invites useful information before agreeing on support?
 - A. There cannot be any reasonable explanation.
 - B. You should already know what I am thinking.
 - C. What is making this part of the task difficult?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can explain a practical obstacle affecting the work. Share it after your partner asks for your perspective, then agree on one observable change.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response, not a script to memorize. Your written version needs a subject line, an opening, and appropriate context. Assess it using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Project Charter and Scope Definition

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: what this means.

Check 1: B - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

B: The embedded question uses subject then verb: the review starts.

C: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

Check 2: A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

B: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

C: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

Model response: Who will use the dashboard, and what decision should it support? Let's agree on those needs and the exclusions before we estimate the work or call the scope complete.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Schedule, Critical Path, and Dependencies

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: A - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

B: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

C: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

Check 2: C - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

B: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

C: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

Model response: Testing is three days late and is blocking the release rehearsal. Other tasks remain on schedule. I'll show the dependency and the proposed recovery options in the schedule update.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Risk Register and Issue Escalation

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: C - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

B: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

C: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

Check 2: B - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: This removes uncertainty rather than explaining its limits.

B: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

C: The pilot does not establish future results everywhere.

Model response: The delay is now a confirmed issue, not only a future risk. I'll update its status and ask the responsible owner to document the impact and next action.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Stakeholder Alignment and Governance

Editing example: Before I record agreement, does anyone have a concern or need more time?

The revised question gives people a way to raise a concern. Silence can have several meanings, especially in unfamiliar or unequal-power situations.

Check 1: B - We haven't heard from the remote team yet; what is your view?

A: Recording agreement without checking may misrepresent the team's view.

B: It invites participation without interpreting silence as consent.

C: Silence does not establish agreement.

Check 2: A - Approval is pending; the sponsor will review the two options.

A: This distinguishes discussion from approval and identifies the next reviewer.

B: Discussion does not itself constitute approval.

C: Participation alone does not establish a decision.

Model response: We have a recommendation, but approval is still outstanding. Who has authority to approve this change, and what information do they need? I'll record the decision route in the meeting notes.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Change Requests and Scope Creep

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the if-clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Check 1: A - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: The if-clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

B: The tense pattern and time reference do not express the intended future condition.

C: The conflicting time references make the condition unclear.

Check 2: C - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

B: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

C: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

Model response: We can assess the new report as a scope change. To include it, we would need to move another feature or extend the schedule. Which tradeoff should we develop for review?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Status Reporting and Executive Updates

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: C - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

B: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

C: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

Check 2: B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

B: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

C: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

Model response: The current label does not show the unresolved dependency. I'll report the delivery threat, its impact, and the decision needed so the status reflects the agreed criteria.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Vendor and Cross-Functional Delivery

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: B - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: A later date does not meet a 'by Thursday' deadline.

B: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

C: This reverses the meaning of the deadline.

Check 2: A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: The requested action and information are explicit.

B: 'Relevant matters' and 'soon' leave the task unclear.

C: This expression does not identify the specific action needed.

Model response: Could you provide the evidence for these two criteria or identify any outstanding work? We need to review the deliverable against the agreed criteria before confirming acceptance.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Post-Implementation Review

Editing example: The last two reports omitted the agreed summary section.

The revision identifies observable work. 'Always' and a personality judgment make the feedback harder to verify or act on.

Check 1: A - The last two updates omitted the agreed completion date.

A: The recipient can check the specific examples and discuss how to improve them.

B: This assumes motivation rather than describing behavior.

C: This labels a person rather than an action.

Check 2: C - What is making this part of the task difficult?

A: This closes off relevant information.

B: This relies on unstated expectations.

C: An open question may reveal a barrier the speaker has not considered.

Model response: Which message or handoff caused difficulty, and what happened as a result? Let's turn that example into a specific change, assign an owner, and decide how we will check whether it helped.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.